



THE FRUITBAT

Kale Growing Guide



A simple care guide for the kale giveaway • October 24



Your kale was started from seed in late September and early October, so when you receive it, it will be about 3–4 weeks old. Some plants may be ready for their permanent home immediately, while slightly younger ones may appreciate a few more days in their starter container.



Quick Care



Sunlight

6+ hours of sun is ideal. Give tender seedlings a gentle transition if the weather is still warm.



Watering

Keep soil evenly moist but not soggy. Check the soil instead of watering on a strict schedule.



Soil

Use fertile, well-draining soil or quality potting mix.



Season

Kale is a cool-season crop, which makes fall and winter a great time to grow it.



Container Friendly

Yes, just give it enough root space and drainage.



Difficulty

Beginner friendly



1 Your First Few Days

Look at your plant, not just the date.

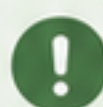
Some seedlings will be ready to transplant right away, while others may benefit from 5–7 more days in the starter cup.



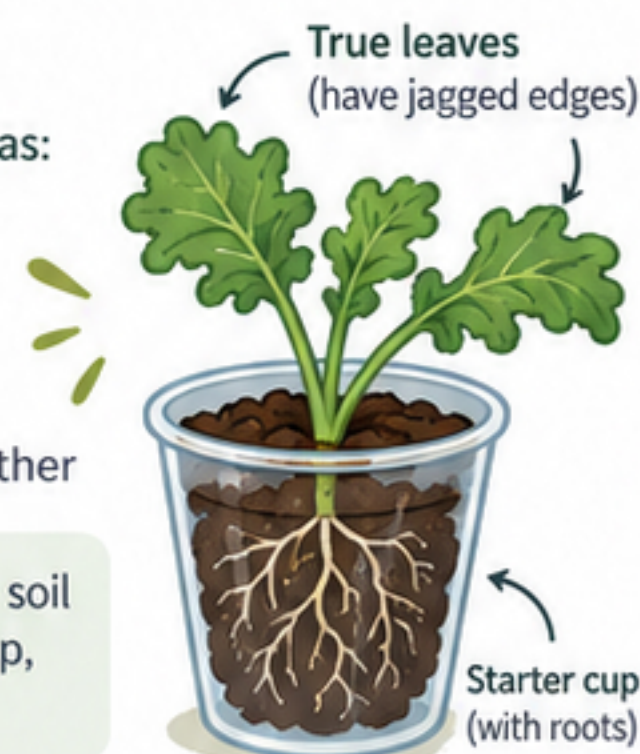
2 Ready to Transplant?

Your kale is likely ready for a new home if it has:

- ✓ Several true kale leaves
- ✓ A sturdy upright stem
- ✓ Active new growth
- ✓ Roots beginning to hold the soil together



If the seedling is still very small or the soil falls apart when removed from the cup, wait a few more days.



3 Sunlight

Start with morning sun or bright outdoor light, then gradually move toward a sunnier growing location. Once established, kale does best with about 6–8 hours of sun.



Day 1–2

Morning sun or bright light



Day 3–4

A few more hours of sun



Full growing location

6–8 hours of sun daily

4 Watering

Stick a finger into the top of the soil. If the surface is drying, water. If it is still moist, wait. Water thoroughly, then let excess water drain.



Stick your finger about 1 inch into the soil.



Water thoroughly, then let excess water drain.



Grow food. Share knowledge. Grow together.



www.thefruitbat.org